

VESPERTILIONIDAE

Consisting of 496 species, the Vespertilionidae is the largest family of bats. Known as evening or common bats, they are distributed worldwide excluding the polar regions, and are mostly insectivorous. They typically have a plain nose and small eyes.



5–6 cm
2–2¼ in

SCHREIBER'S BENT-WINGED BAT

Miniopterus schreibersii

Possessing long finger bones and broad wings, Schreiber's bat is patchily distributed in southwestern Europe and N. and W. Africa.



ears joined
at base

6–9 cm
2¼–3½ in

4–6 cm
1½–2¼ in

5–8.5 cm
2–3¼ in

GREY LONG-EARED BAT

Plecotus austriacus

The grey long-eared bat's ears are almost the same length as its body. It lives in southern and C. Europe and N. Africa.

BIG BROWN BAT

Eptesicus fuscus

Often found roosting in buildings, the insectivorous big brown bat is distributed from S. Canada to N. Brazil and some Caribbean islands.

COMMON NOCTULE

Nyctalus noctula

A fast and powerful flier with narrow, blackish-brown wings, the noctule is found across N.E. Europe and parts of Asia.

EUROPEAN PARTICOLOURED BAT

Vespertilio murinus

This pale-bellied, dark-backed bat is native to mountain, steppe, and forest habitats from E. and C. Europe to Asia. It is also found in urban areas.

4.5–6.5 cm
2–2½ in

4–5 cm
1½–2 in

NATTERER'S BAT

Myotis nattereri

From N.W. Africa, across Europe to S.W. Asia, Natterer's bat catches insects in its fringed tail membrane during a slow, hovering flight.



4–5 cm
1½–2 in

3.5–5.5 cm
1½–2¼ in

4.5–5.5 cm
1¾–2¼ in

EASTERN PIPISTRELLE

Perimyotis subflavus

The eastern pipistrelle hibernates in rock crevices, mines, and caves during winter. Its range covers eastern N. America, from S. Canada to N. Honduras.

COMMON PIPISTRELLE

Pipistrellus pipistrellus

The most widespread pipistrelle species, the common pipistrelle's range extends from W. Europe to the Far East and N. Africa.

NATHUSIUS' PIPISTRELLE

Pipistrellus nathusii

A long-distance migrant capable of journeys of over 1,900 km (1,200 miles) in spring and autumn, this species mainly occurs in E. and C. Europe.

FRINGED MYOTIS

Myotis thysanodes

Named after a fringe of hairs along the edge of its tail membrane, this myotis bat lives in western N. America.

4.5–6 cm
2–2¼ in

DAUBENTON'S BAT

Myotis daubentonii

This Eurasian bat has relatively large feet, which help it to catch flying insects emerging from the surface of bodies of water.

4.5–5.5 cm
2–2¼ in

